

Yavuz Erkan

Unorthodox Aphorisms



Yavuz Erkan photographs his own body, undertaking somewhat slight, short-lived gestures in tandem with ephemera of the everyday.

His image production is inherently photographic, that is, the sharp points of focus and deepening soft blur emphasise the plurality Erkan aims to poeticise in "the power relationships between showing, looking and being looked at".¹

While I don't see these relationships as a struggle (in a traditional sense), Erkan's installation strategy, a grid of framed photographs, highlights a kind of willful desire. The eye moves back and forth, through a range of hues that are highly sensual – broken by stark white frames – which further concentrates the act of looking, in such a way that it becomes quite reflective.

In a recent lecture, Andrew Benjamin gave an example of how our engagement with the world is filmic and how the photograph and the photographic dominate how we think about our own bodies.

He described what he saw as he looked through the window of a shop-front, around 5 or 6 o'clock in the evening:

"I see myself seeing, because I look through the glass and in the glass I see myself reflected back. Not only do I see myself seeing, I see myself desiring. I see myself desiring what I cannot have. I see a complex series of me's. I am always seeing more than one."²

¹ Y. Erkan, *Artist Statement*, 2011.

² A. Benjamin, *From Fear to Instability: On the Philosophy of Photography*, Federation Hall, Victorian College of the Arts, 24 April, 2012.

Yavuz Erkan *Bubble gum* 2011, Archival Pigment Print, courtesy of the artist.



Yavuz Erkan *Towel* 2011, Archival Pigment Print, courtesy of the artist.

